

ALL INDIA DISCOMs ASSOCIATION (AIDA)
Minutes of 1st Meeting of Committee on Capacity Building

Minutes of 1st Meeting of Committee on Capacity Building held virtually on 1st July, 2025 at 12.00 noon.

At the outset, Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (Regulatory Affairs) of AIDA welcomed the members of the AIDA Committee on Capacity Building. He emphasized the need for effective training programs and webinars to improve the skills of personnel at various levels. The first session of the AIDA Committee on Capacity Building focused on enhancing human resource capacity within organizations, particularly in Discoms. During the meeting, the following issues were discussed with the respective Members of Discoms:

1. Opening Remarks

Shri Alok Kumar, DG, AIDA welcomed the members and highlighted capacity building as a key intervention for strengthening Discom personnel. He outlined three initiatives – international/national study tours (including the recent Manila visit and upcoming Thailand tour), experience sharing on best practices (such as decentralized solar in Maharashtra), and institutional training (draft curriculum for SE-level officers with MoP funding support). He also encouraged members to suggest further areas for capacity building, including managerial training for senior officers.

2. Training Modules Proposed

DG, AIDA proposed two training modules prepared by NPTI, a 3-day and a 5-day program for SE-level officers, seeking committee members' views. He suggested that while the 3-day module is compact, the 5-day module would provide greater impact, covering topics such as climate change and energy economics, policy and regulatory aspects, financial management, leadership and data-driven decision making, power market design with case studies, renewable energy integration, and a field visit to advanced battery storage facilities. Members were requested to give their preference on duration (3 or 5 days), relevance for SE-level officers, and suggestions on inclusion or modification of topics.

3. Member Suggestions

Shri Anand Budholia (BSES): Preferred a 5-day program. Supported inclusion of cyber security and emphasized that a field visit should form an essential part of the program.

Shri Prasad Patki (BSES): Suggested inclusion of case studies to make the course content more engaging.

Shri Arvind Bhatikar, CGM (T&S), Nashik, MSEDCL: Favoured a 3-day program considering SEs' role as district heads and time constraints. Suggested focus on safety measures (due to frequent accidents) and network planning.

Shri Ravi Aggarwal, CE, MVVNL Lucknow: Preferred a 3-day program. Recommended emphasis on leadership effectiveness and inclusion of soft skills training to strengthen interaction with government departments and political stakeholders.

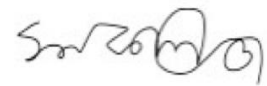
Shri Dinesh Jethwani, DGM, PGVCL: Supported a 5-day program for SE-level and above.

Suggested inclusion of emotional intelligence and artificial intelligence. Noted that nominations should preferably exclude officers with less than two years of service left before retirement.

Ms. Reena Suri, ISGF: Strongly favoured a 5-day program as it would be a lifetime learning opportunity for participants. Stressed the importance of field visits, case studies, cyber security, digital technologies deployment, and smart metering, which is a current focus of government and utilities.

4. Emerging Consensus

In his concluding remarks, DG, AIDA observed that the members broadly agreed that the training program should offer a holistic overview rather than an overly technical treatment, with emphasis on practical exposure through case studies and field visits. While a few members expressed preference for the 3-day module due to time constraints, the majority supported the 5-day module, considering it more comprehensive and impactful.



(Satyendra Nath Kalita)

Convenor, AIDA Committee